ASSEM MERZOUG

Web & API Penetration Tester

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PROFILE

Junior penetration tester focused on web applications and APIs. Fifteen retired HackTheBox machines taken to root or Domain Admin and written up as full client reports —scope, evidence, reproduction, remediation. I work manually in Burp Suite before reaching for a scanner, and I document every step so a developer can reproduce the finding without me.

SKILLS

Testing. Broken access control, IDOR, business-logic flaws, SQL injection, XSS, SSRF, template injection, file upload, authentication and session flaws.

Tooling. Burp Suite, sqlmap, ffuf, Nmap, Wireshark, hashcat, custom Python clients and exploit scripts.

Languages. Python, JavaScript, Bash, SQL. Comfortable reading a codebase to find where an input is trusted.

SELECTED WORK

Penetration test reports —ctf-writeups

Fifteen HackTheBox machines (Linux and Windows, including an Active Directory domain) documented end to end in the structure used for client work. Each report carries the request or command that proves the finding, the escalation path, and the fix.

pdfsmith —report engine

A zero-dependency Python library that builds the client-ready PDFs above from structured findings. Written because the report is part of the deliverable, not an afterthought.

web-pentest-field-manual · web-pentester-roadmap

Two reference repositories I maintain: a methodology manual, and a six-volume roadmap that documents what I am studying and in what order.

Bug bounty

A business-logic finding submitted to a public bug bounty program (Intigriti, 2026): coupon stacking in a store checkout that let repeated discounts compound.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance —self-employed · 2021 to present

Five years of independent client work, security-focused since 2023, run alongside the degree: requirements, delivery and a written handover for every engagement.

EDUCATION

BSc Electrical Engineering

Final project: modelling and simulation of a three-phase voltage inverter with Space Vector PWM.

MSc Automation & Systems Engineering —University of Palermo

In progress.

CERTIFICATIONS IN PROGRESS

BSCP (Burp Suite Certified Practitioner) and CWES in progress; OSCP as the long-term target.